

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *yavānī* (IAST: *yavānī*; lit. “ajwain — *Trachyspermum ammi*”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Botanical identification.** *Trachyspermum ammi*. Small seeds (closer to caraway than parsley). Distinctive sharp aroma. Leaves of the plant resemble parsley.
2. **Active compound.** Thymol (35-60% of essential oil). Same compound as in thyme. Strong antimicrobial and digestive-stimulating actions.
3. **Traditional uses.** Caraka cites *yavānī* primarily for digestive complaints: indigestion, gas, colic. The traditional remedy: a few seeds chewed after a heavy meal.
4. **Modern research.** Thymol’s antimicrobial effect is well-documented in food science (it’s used as a natural preservative). Limited clinical research on traditional digestive claims, but the underlying chemistry is plausible.
5. **Discussion.** “*Why is the same compound (thymol) found in ajwain and thyme — plants from very different families?*” This is *convergent evolution* in plant chemistry: distantly related plants evolving the same defensive compound. A great cross-cultural pharmacology insight.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Ajwain — Carom Seed.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 *pañcabhūta*).